Activities to Improve your Emotional Intelligence

There are five core components of Emotional Intelligence as suggested by Daniel Goleman are:

- **Self-awareness.**
- **Self-regulation.**
- **Motivation.**
- **Empathy.**
- **Social skills**

Each activity that is suggested below focuses on one core aspect.

6 Emotional Intelligence Activities to Improve EQ Skills:

Activity 1: Self-Awareness

Strength Worksheet

This worksheet of enhancing your self-awareness comes from **Florida State University.**

It starts with an amazing point that states: It's hard to make changes to yourself when you aren't sure where to start! Enhancing your self-awareness will help you figure out what your strengths are, where your EQ competency levels lie, and where you should focus your self-improvement efforts.

The **worksheet lists 30 strengths or character traits** that you might feel are strengths or areas for you to improve. This list includes traits like:

- Creative
- Confident
- Positive
- Funny
- Curious
- Imaginative
- Hard-working

On one side, there is space to identify three strengths you have and on the other, there is space to identify three traits you would like to work on.

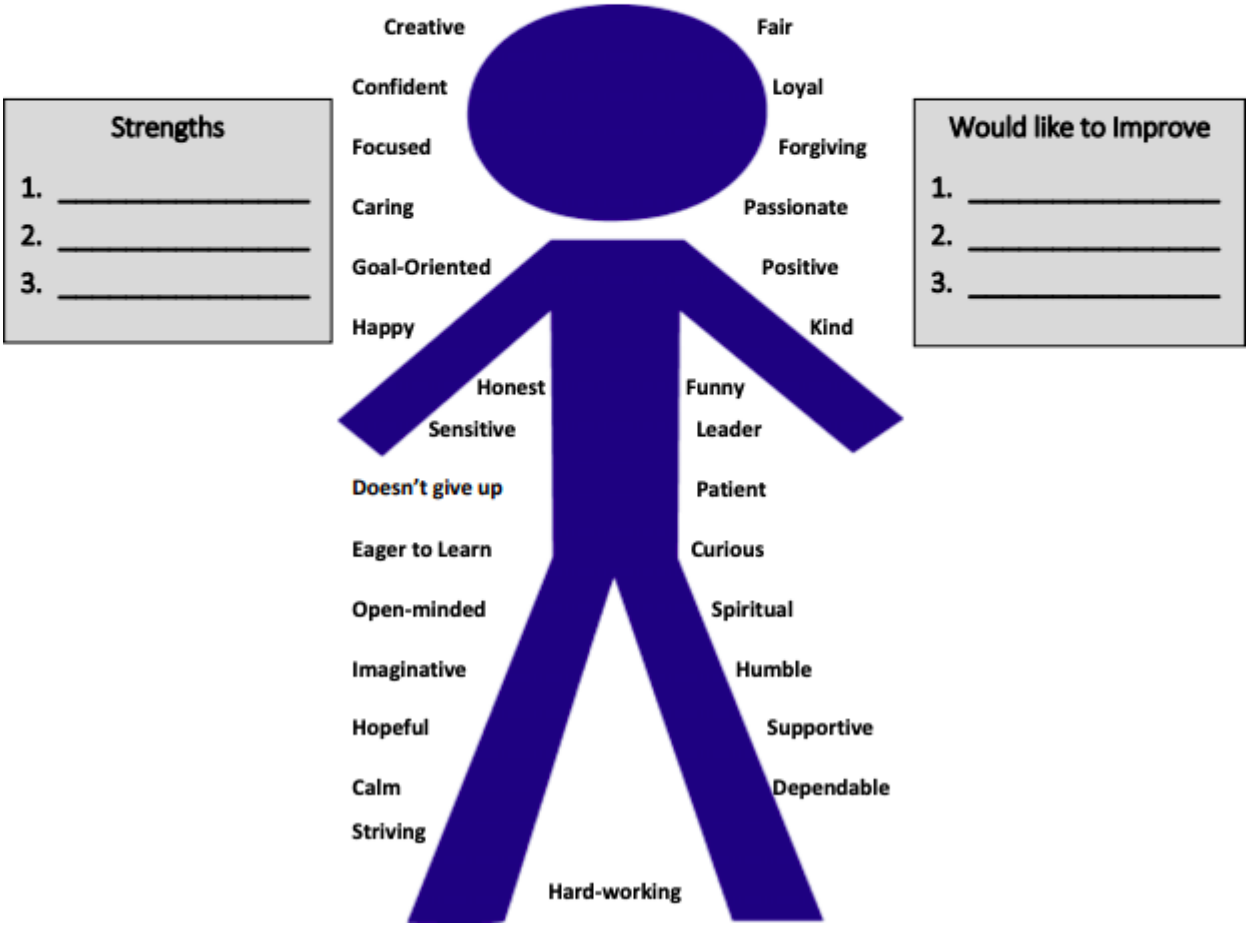
If you think of any strength or an area you'd like to improve that is not included on the list, add it in any way. Your list should be personalized to you, so add and edit what you need!

Template:

Self-Awareness Activity

Before you can make changes in yourself, you have to know what there is to work with. Becoming self-aware is about the process of understanding yourself. We all have strengths and limitations. Self-awareness can be developed and identifying your strengths and weaknesses can help with this development. Spend some time recognizing areas you need to develop and intentionally make an effort to develop or strengthen that aspect of yourself.

Choose three strengths for yourself, and three you would like to improve on. If you don't see a trait listed here, feel free to write your own! Once you've chosen traits that need improving, think about and describe how you will attempt to improve those traits.



Activity 2: Self-Regulation

Be the Fog

It can be very difficult for many of us to accept criticism, especially if receiving criticism provokes strong emotions. This simple exercise will help you "be the fog" and learn how to regulate and modulate your emotions in a **difficult situation.**

Here's what to do:

"Act like a fog! Imagine you are a fog. When someone throws a stone at you, you absorb that stone without throwing the stone back. This is a very easy and effective technique to use against people who keep criticizing you repeatedly." (Skills Converged website)

For example, if someone tells you something like:

- "You just don't get it."
- "You are always procrastinating."
- "You are always late."
- "You run away from responsibilities."

Respond with:

- "Yes, I just don't get it."
- "Yes, I am procrastinating sometimes."
- "Yes, I was late."
- "Yes, I just don't take responsibility."

By accepting these criticisms that are thrown your way (without actually taking them to the heart), you will find that you disarm the person criticizing you. To practice, ask someone you know well to criticize you at rapid speed, one after the other, and employ the fogging technique to counter it.

Activity 3: For Relationships

Relationship Skills

This worksheet is a good way to work on building your core EQ competencies and relationship skills.

The worksheet opens with the following instructions:

- Write the names of three of the most **important people in your life.**
- Think about what you know about each **person and list two traits**, hobbies, or features of each of them (e.g., someone runs marathons and tells funny jokes).

Finally, the worksheet provides a tip if you're having trouble:

- If you had trouble listing something about the people in your life, you may want to pay more attention to those around you. Learning something unique or personal about the individuals in your **life can help you maintain caring and positive** relationships.

Relationship Management Activity

In this activity, for each of the green circles, write the names of important people in your life. Then, think about what you know about that person. List two traits, hobbies, or features related to the person in the designated boxes. For example: Bob Smith 1) Runs marathons 2) Tells funny jokes.



If you had trouble listing something about the people in your life, you may want to pay more attention to those around you. Learning something unique or personal about the individuals in your life can help you maintain caring and positive relationships.

Activity 4: Developing Empathy

Stress Management

A major roadblock in developing empathetic skills is STRESS. The **stress we experience reduces our level** of empathy. Therefore, it is important to **manage this stress** to be empathetic and improve emotional intelligence.

Recent studies have indicated that people with emotional clarity and awareness are better at **handling stress** than others. Especially in the workplace, **stress and burnout cause** a marked degradation in our overall emotional capabilities and influence the way we respond to them.

The most helpful stress reduction method is by consciously using our senses and staying close to nature.

- Splash cold water on your face after a stressful encounter and get back to work after that. Along with giving a feeling of freshness, cool conditions also help us in **reducing anxiety** levels.
- Avoiding unhelpful habits like- caffeine intake and drug abuse, during hard times.
- Take a break from things that welcome stress and redshift your focus on activities that boost your mental and emotional well-being.

Activity 5: Get Motivated

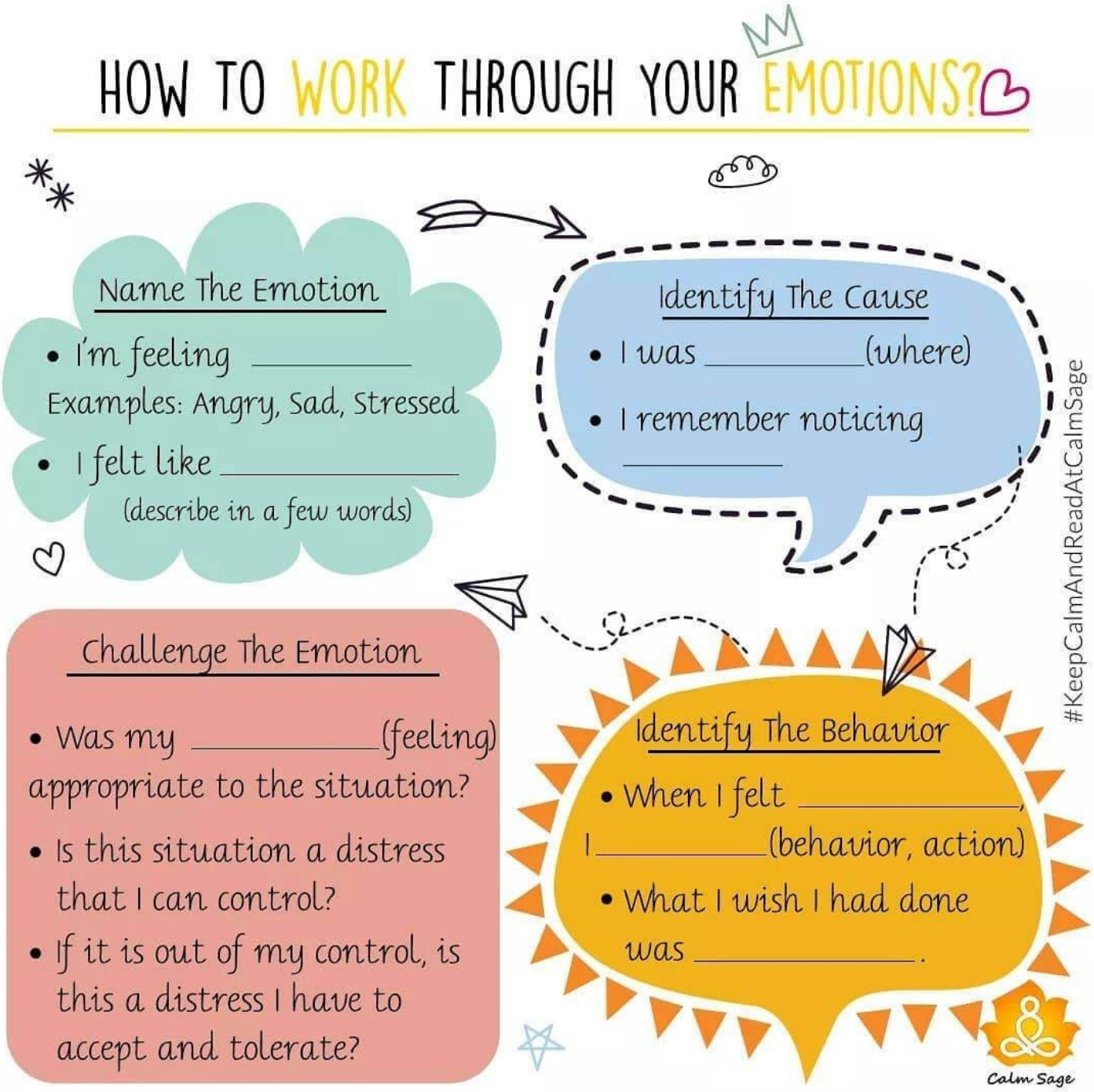
Watch a TED Talk

TED Talks are believed to be a great source of motivation. So, to work on the fifth core element of emotional intelligence all you have to do is watch this (CLICK) **TED Talk** and get motivated.

Here is a TED Talk to make your journey of boosting your emotional intelligence even better

Activity 6: Working on Emotions

Here is an interactive graphic that will help you recognize and work on your emotions. If you are looking to work on all the five components of emotional intelligence together then this is a great activity to opt for.



You can either take a screenshot and work on it or jot the steps down on a paper as you work on a given task. Enjoy!!!

Now that you have a list of fun-filled exercises to improve emotional intelligence it is time for you to try some or maybe all of them.

Keep expressing… keep smiling…